

COMPETITIVE BENCHMARK

Shelter Registration and Family Reunification Application

UXD-HCI analysis based on the 2026 benchmarking guideline

Applications analyzed: Safe & Well (USA) · RedSafe (ICRC) · Register.Find.Reunite (Australia) · Refugee Assistance Information System (RAIS) · Restoring Family Links · American Red Cross Shelter Map

Universidad de La Frontera · User Experience Design and Human-Computer Interaction · October 2026

1. Objective, scope, and selection criteria

This benchmark identifies domain standards, experience gaps, and differentiation opportunities for a solution that allows people to be registered in shelters, searched across multiple locations, and safely reconnected with relatives during emergencies.

The six tools were selected because together they cover direct competitors, analogous solutions, and design references. Although the course guideline recommends 3-5 tools as a typical range, all six are retained here because each represents a distinct part of the problem space: status registration, family tracing, institutional case management, privacy, and shelter discovery.

Tool	Classification	Why it is relevant
Safe & Well - American Red Cross	Direct competitor	Addresses disaster status registration and family lookup in the United States. It is highly relevant to the “I am safe / find someone” flow.
RedSafe - ICRC	Analog competitor / design reference	Provides secure humanitarian services, messaging, maps, and partial offline use. It is valuable for privacy and progressive access patterns.
Register.Find.Reunite - Australian Red Cross	Direct competitor	Combines registration, search, and permission-based reunification during declared emergencies.
Refugee Assistance Information System (RAIS) - UNHCR	Analog competitor / institutional reference	Shows how humanitarian organizations structure case management, assistance, referrals, and reporting for multiple actors.
Restoring Family Links - ICRC / Family Links Network	Direct humanitarian service	Focuses on tracing missing relatives, restoring contact, confidentiality, consent, and human mediation.
American Red Cross Shelter Map	Design reference	Provides a direct geographic pattern for discovering shelters and disaster services without requiring sign-in.

2. Analysis dimensions

The benchmark applies the mandatory dimensions from the guideline and four domain-specific dimensions so that all six tools can be compared consistently.

Base dimension	What is observed
Identification	Name, organization, platform, availability, and analysis date.
Target user profile	Who the tool is for and the emergency or assistance context in which it is used.
Value proposition	What problem it solves and what differentiates its approach.
Main features	Priority functions and the frequency or criticality of their use.
Onboarding flow	Steps, registration, permissions, or institutional dependencies before the main action.
Navigation patterns	Access structure, depth, and hierarchy of tasks.
Visual design and consistency	Observable hierarchy, density, iconography, and organization.
Observable accessibility	Language support, alternative channels, labels, touch targets, and visible barriers.
Notable strengths	At least two positive, evidence-based UX decisions.
Areas for improvement	At least two problems or limitations linked to UX principles.

Domain-specific dimension	What is evaluated
Low-connectivity operation	Offline use, downloadable content, or alternative channels when Internet access fails.
Time to critical action	How many conceptual steps separate the user from “register,” “search,” or “find a shelter.”
Privacy and consent	Who can see data, what is shared, and how a person-to-person connection is authorized.
Coordination across shelters / institutions	Ability to consult, transfer, or coordinate information between sites, organizations, or teams.

3. Executive benchmark summary

Tool	Primary strength	Primary weakness / limitation	Design lesson
Safe & Well	Two simple tasks: list yourself as safe or search for someone.	Search depends on known information and does not model a shelter network as the core object.	Keep the entry point focused on two critical actions and support short status messages.
Register.Find.Reunite	Integrates Register + Find + Reunite and lets people control what others can see.	Only operates when activated for an emergency.	Separate registration, search, and validation/reunification; require consent before sharing details.
Restoring Family Links	Global network, confidentiality, and human support for complex cases.	Tracing may depend on office contact and human follow-up instead of immediate self-service.	Escalate sensitive or uncertain matches to authorized staff.
RAIS	Structured case management, assistance, referrals, and multi-actor coordination.	Institutional access; internal workflows are not publicly testable.	Use roles, referrals, and traceability without exposing administrative complexity to citizens.
RedSafe	Privacy by design, public services without an account, and downloadable resources.	Limited geographic coverage and reduced web functionality compared with mobile.	Use progressive access, encryption, and selective offline capability.
Shelter Map	Finds shelters and services through a map with no onboarding.	Finds services but does not register people or support reunification by itself.	Combine map + list discovery with updated operational shelter cards.

Cross-cutting finding: The strongest references separate the immediate action (register, search, or locate a service) from sensitive processes such as identity verification, consent, case management, and inter-institutional coordination.

4. Safe & Well - American Red Cross (USA)

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Direct competitor.
Identification	Public American Red Cross web service; analysis based on the current loved-ones/reunification pages and available official documentation as of October 2026.
Target users	People affected by disasters in the United States who want to report that they are safe; relatives and friends looking for someone's status.
Value proposition	Provide a central point where people can publish a post-disaster status and loved ones can check that status.
Main features	• “Safe & Well” status registration.

Dimension	Analysis
	• Search for registered people. • Short/predefined status messages. • Assisted Red Cross channels for cases requiring welfare inquiry or reunification.
Onboarding	The public logic centers on two tasks: list yourself as safe and well or search for someone. Historical official documentation describes registration and search without requiring a persistent account.
Navigation	Task-oriented navigation: “list myself” versus “search.” The current help area integrates Safe & Well into “Contact & Locate Loved Ones.”
Visual design	The current Red Cross site uses a clear institutional hierarchy with help-oriented calls to action. The specific Safe & Well interface could not be fully inspected from current public sources, so final visual assessment requires direct capture.
Observable accessibility	Content is available in English and Spanish, and the American Red Cross provides human/telephone channels in some cases. A full WCAG audit of the Safe & Well form was not performed.
Low-connectivity operation	No offline mode was verified. Human assistance channels provide an alternative when digital self-service is insufficient.
Time to critical action	Low: the conceptual architecture starts with two direct actions.
Privacy and consent	The search does not expose an open public directory of people; it depends on identifying information and status messages. Sensitive cases can be escalated to Red Cross staff.
Coordination across institutions	The organization can support welfare inquiries and reunification, but no public cross-shelter coordination dashboard was observed.

Notable strengths

- Clear visibility of primary actions reduces decision load by separating “report that I am safe” from “search for someone.”
- Minimal public content: a short status message can satisfy the core need without turning the service into a social network.

Areas for improvement

- Search depends on information the requester already knows. If the flow requires name plus phone number or previous address, retrieval may fail when data are incomplete or remembered incorrectly (error prevention / flexibility).
- The service communicates status but does not explicitly model movement between shelters; the proposed project needs controlled shelter history or current-location tracking.

Sources: [S1], [S2]

5. RedSafe - ICRC

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Analog competitor / design reference.
Identification	Mobile application for iOS/Android plus a web version with limited functionality, managed by the ICRC. Available only in selected countries.
Target users	People affected by conflict, migration, and other humanitarian crises who need information, services, documents, or secure communication.
Value proposition	Bring secure and confidential humanitarian services together in a platform based on “security and privacy by design.”

Dimension	Analysis
Main features	• Information as Aid. • Humanitarian services map. • Alerts. • Digital Vault for documents and contacts. • Predefined messages with geolocation, selfie, and contact details. • Access to services for finding relatives.
Onboarding	Information as Aid, Map of Services, and alerts can be used without registration. Digital Vault and Messages require an account; registration can use email and/or phone with OTP authentication.
Navigation	Service-based architecture from the Home screen. Users enter independent modules and use search/filters within each one.
Visual design	Service-oriented design with clearly differentiated modules and a map as a spatial pattern. This reduces coupling between critical and complementary functions.
Observable accessibility	Available in multiple languages. Some functions are public without an account. A full WCAG audit was not performed.
Low-connectivity operation	Partial and explicit: selected articles, points of interest, and documents can be downloaded for offline use; the full map does not work offline.
Time to critical action	Medium: access to map/information is immediate, but sensitive functions require registration/OTP.
Privacy and consent	Strong: encryption, ICRC data-protection rules, and visibility controls; users can choose whether they appear in messaging searches.
Coordination across institutions	Connects ICRC and humanitarian-partner services, but it is not designed as a shared shelter-management console.

Notable strengths

- Progressive disclosure: people can access information, maps, and alerts without creating an account; authentication is introduced only for personal data or messaging.
- Resilience: selected articles, points of interest, and documents can be downloaded for offline consultation.

Areas for improvement

- Incomplete parity across platforms: the web version has fewer capabilities than the mobile app, creating consistency and expectation issues.
- Messaging requires both users to have accounts and to know the other person's username; not being able to search by email or phone adds friction to urgent reunification.

Sources: [S3], [S4]

6. Register.Find.Reunite - Australian Red Cross

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Direct competitor.
Identification	Web service managed by Australian Red Cross on behalf of government agencies; activated only during emergencies.
Target users	People affected by fires, floods, or other emergencies; relatives/friends; and emergency services that need to know the whereabouts of affected people.
Value proposition	Allow people to register that they are safe, search for someone who may be affected, and, with permission, share information to facilitate reunification.
Main features	• Register: report that you are safe and what you are doing. • Find: search for an affected person.

Dimension	Analysis
	• Reunite: matching and connection with permission. • Access from the website and evacuation/recovery centres. • Institutional use to understand affected people's locations and reduce unnecessary searches.
Onboarding	When active, the user chooses between Register and Find. In-person support at evacuation/recovery centres reduces dependence on digital self-service.
Navigation	Highly intention-oriented navigation: Register / Find; Reunite occurs later as a matching and consent process.
Visual design	The public Australian Red Cross page prioritizes a concise explanation and direct access. The operational interface can only be observed while the service is activated, so full screenshots depend on an active event or official material.
Observable accessibility	The web channel is complemented by access at evacuation and recovery centres. Offline support and a complete accessibility audit of the operational form were not verified.
Low-connectivity operation	No technical offline mode was verified. Physical service points partially compensate for connectivity constraints.
Time to critical action	Very low when active: the two primary actions are explicit.
Privacy and consent	High: users control what information is visible and Reunite shares details with permission.
Coordination across institutions	High: emergency services can access location information and the service is administered for government agencies.

Notable strengths

- Direct mapping between user need and action: Register and Find use understandable verbs and closely match the user's mental model.
- Explicit consent in Reunite: the connection happens with permission and users control what information others can see.

Areas for improvement

- Conditional availability: the service operates only during emergencies, which makes prior learning, testing, and familiarization difficult.
- No documented offline mode was found; continuity depends on the web service or assistance at evacuation/recovery centres.

Sources: [S5]

7. Refugee Assistance Information System (RAIS) - UNHCR

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Analog competitor / institutional reference.
Identification	Secure UNHCR web platform for assistance management. Public instances expose the sign-in screen and module names; operational use requires credentials.
Target users	UNHCR staff, implementing partners, and donors coordinating assistance for refugee populations.
Value proposition	Track and coordinate assistance, improve accountability, and reduce duplication of effort between actors.
Main features	• Case Management. • Assistance. • Referrals. • xForms.

Dimension	Analysis
	• Education in some instances. • Reporting.
Onboarding	Institutional authentication. No public beneficiary self-service is visible in the observed interface.
Navigation	The public surface shows modular navigation by functional area: Case Management, Assistance, Referrals, xForms, and Reporting.
Visual design	The public login surface is functional and institutional. It was not possible to responsibly evaluate consistency of internal screens without authorized credentials.
Observable accessibility	The contact page includes CAPTCHA with an audio alternative, but a full accessibility audit of the internal system could not be performed.
Low-connectivity operation	No sufficient public evidence was found to claim that RAIS supports offline operation.
Time to critical action	High for an external user who cannot sign in; appropriate for an authorized staff member who already has credentials.
Privacy and consent	Official documentation describes it as a secure web platform with restricted public access. Internal controls that were not observed are not inferred.
Coordination across institutions	Very high: RAIS was created for tracking, coordination, accountability, and reducing duplication across multiple actors.

Notable strengths

- Modular functional architecture separates case management, assistance, referrals, and reporting, supporting institutional workflow organization.
- Multi-actor orientation: its stated purpose is to coordinate assistance and reduce duplication across organizations.

Areas for improvement

- Necessary but high access barrier: institutional authentication prevents self-service by affected people. The proposed project should clearly separate the staff interface from the citizen/family experience.
- Methodological limitation: the internal interface is not public, so the guideline requirement to walk through two main flows cannot be fully met without a test account.

Sources: [S6], [S7], [S8]

8. Restoring Family Links (RFL) - ICRC / Family Links Network

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Direct humanitarian service.
Identification	Global service and website administered by the ICRC together with the network of National Red Cross and Red Crescent Societies.
Target users	People who have lost contact with relatives because of conflict, disaster, migration, or another humanitarian crisis.
Value proposition	Trace missing relatives, restore and maintain contact, and facilitate reunification when possible and appropriate.
Main features	• Family tracing. • Restoring contact. • Reunification when possible. • Calls, messages, and other communication channels. • Office locator and emergency-specific forms in selected contexts.
Onboarding	The public site explains the start in three steps: find the nearest office, get in touch, and provide

Dimension	Analysis
	as much information as possible. Specific emergencies may provide online forms.
Navigation	Shallow navigation: current emergency / how it works / office / contact / FAQ. The case is then handled by the humanitarian network.
Visual design	The public interface prioritizes safety messages, numbered steps, and help content. It maintains a simple hierarchy for users under stress.
Observable accessibility	The service operates globally and the site provides multiple language versions. The network also works in person and through phone/message channels.
Low-connectivity operation	It is not an offline application, but the network provides human and alternative communication channels, creating operational resilience beyond the website.
Time to critical action	Medium: starting a request requires three conceptual steps and contact with the network; some contexts allow an online form.
Privacy and consent	Very high: data are confidential, used only for tracing, and disclosed only with consent.
Coordination across institutions	Very high: the Family Links Network connects 192 National Societies, ICRC delegations, and the IFRC.

Notable strengths

- Very understandable starting process: three visible steps reduce uncertainty and explain what will happen next.
- Protection of autonomy: information remains confidential and is disclosed only with consent; if a person does not want contact, that decision is respected.

Areas for improvement

- Dependence on human mediation: users do not necessarily receive immediate results and cannot always complete a match independently.
- Uncertain resolution time: every case is different, so the interface cannot offer a uniform timeline, which may increase anxiety.

Sources: [S9], [S10]

9. American Red Cross Shelter Map

Dimension	Analysis
Classification	Design reference.
Identification	Public American Red Cross web tool for locating open shelters and other disaster-relief service sites.
Target users	Evacuated or disaster-affected people who need to quickly find a nearby shelter or service.
Value proposition	Turn operational shelter/service information into a public, updated, actionable geographic view.
Main features	• Map of shelters and service sites. • Differentiated pins: tent icon for overnight shelters and standard pins for other services. • Location, services, and hours. • Includes partner-operated sites, not only Red Cross sites.
Onboarding	No account required. Users can enter the map directly and inspect pins; official documentation also describes searching by address or ZIP code.
Navigation	Map-first pattern with point-of-interest selection and detail card. Navigation is shallow because the critical action occurs on the first screen.
Visual design	Spatial hierarchy: map, red pins, differentiated iconography, and service detail cards. Icon

Dimension	Analysis
	semantics help distinguish overnight lodging from other aid points.
Observable accessibility	No identification is required to browse. The organization states that shelters are accessible to people with disabilities; the digital map itself still needs validation with screenshots, keyboard, and screen reader.
Low-connectivity operation	No offline use is documented for the web tool.
Time to critical action	Very low: direct map consultation with no registration.
Privacy and consent	Low handling of personal data for browsing; the tool publishes locations/services, not personal records.
Coordination across institutions	High for service information: the map can include locations operated by partner organizations.

Notable strengths

- Immediate access without an account maximizes speed during an emergency.
- Visual differentiation of site types supports recognition: tent = overnight shelter; simple pin = other services.

Areas for improvement

- Dynamic state: if no nearby shelter is displayed, the site asks users to check again because locations are added as needs evolve. This may create uncertainty at the critical moment.
- A map-first pattern may be insufficient for people with low map literacy or assistive technologies unless an equally clear list alternative is available.

Sources: [S11], [S12]

10. Comparative Feature Map

The goal is to distinguish domain-standard functions, differentiators, and opportunities for the proposed solution. “Mediated” means the function depends on staff or an organization rather than pure self-service.

Feature	Safe & Well	RedSafe	R.F.R. Australia	RAIS	RFL	Shelter Map	Interpretation
Person / status registration	Safe status	Account/profile	Register	Institutional case	Request/case	No	Standard
Person search	Yes, via registered entry	Access to RFL / users by username	Find	Not public-facing	Mediated tracing	No	Reunification standard
Matching / reunification	Record-based match	Not a core feature	Reunite with permission	Not public-facing	Network-mediated	No	Differentiator
Case management	Limited	No	Operational	Yes	Operational	No	Institutional differentiator
Shelter / services map	Not central	Services map	Not central	Not public	Not central	Yes	Integration opportunity
No-account access	Yes / public	Yes for basic modules	Yes when active	No	Public entry	Yes	Desirable standard
Privacy / consent	Non-open registry	Privacy by design	Visibility control	Restricted access	Confidential + consent	Does not handle people	Sensitive standard
Low connectivity	No evidence; human channel	Partial offline downloads	Physical centres	No public evidence	Human channels	No evidence	Critical opportunity
Multi-institutional	Red Cross	ICRC + partners	Public agencies	UNHCR + partners + donors	Global network	Red Cross + partners	Operational standard
“I am safe” status	Yes	Predefined messages	Yes	No	Contact/reconnection	No	Useful standard
Shelter / transfer history	Not visible	No	Not visible	Not verifiable	Not visible	No	OPPORTUNITY
Matching tolerant of incomplete data	Not documented	No	Not documented	Not verifiable	Human tracing	No	OPPORTUNITY

Priority opportunities: 1) Unify registration + search + shelter map. 2) Maintain transfer history without exposing sensitive location. 3) Match across multiple attributes with human verification. 4) Support offline-first shelter staff workflows.

11. Synthetic Comparative Table

Dimension	Safe & Well	RedSafe	R.F.R. Australia	RAIS	RFL	Shelter Map	Group proposal
Target user	Affected people + relatives	People in crisis	Affected people + relatives + emergency services	Staff / partners	Separated families	Evacuees	Shelter staff + relatives
Value	Publish/check status	Secure services in one app	Register, find, reunite	Coordinate assistance	Trace and reconnect families	Find shelters/services	Connect shelter records and support safe reunification
Onboarding	Direct task	Guest for basics; account for sensitive functions	Register/Find when active	Institutional login	3 steps + contact	No account	Two CTAs; authenticated staff, guided family search
Navigation	Register / search	Service-based home	Register / Find; Reunite later	Modules	How it works / office / contact	Map + detail card	Register / Search / Cases / Shelters
Accessibility	EN/ES + assistance	Multilingual; not fully audited	Web + physical centres	Not fully audited; audio CAPTCHA on support form	Multilingual + human service	Public lookup; validate map accessibility	Clear text, high contrast, large fields, list/map alternative
Low connectivity	Human channel; offline not verified	Partial offline downloads	Physical centres; offline not verified	No public evidence	Human channels	No evidence	Offline-first registration; synchronization queue
Privacy	Lookup constrained by identifying data	Encryption + configurable visibility	User control + permission	Secure institutional access	Confidential + consent	No searched-person records	Restricted location; roles; consent before contact
Coordination	Red Cross	ICRC + partners	Agencies + emergency services	UNHCR + partners/donors	192 Societies + ICRC/IFRC	Red Cross + partners	Shelter network with roles, audit trail, and referrals
Critical action	Low friction	Low / medium	Very low	High for public users	Medium	Very low	<1 min registration; partial-data search
Key differentiator	"Safe" status	Privacy by design + partial offline	Permission-based Reunite	Multi-actor case management	Global network + human mediation	Operational map	Registration + map + matching + history + offline

Synthesis: No observed solution combines, in one public-and-operational experience, shelter registration, cross-shelter search, shelter mapping, transfer history, matching tolerant of incomplete data, and offline operation. That combination is the main differentiation opportunity.

12. Findings and design decisions

Decision	Adopt / reject	Rationale
Two visible critical actions	ADOPT	From Safe & Well and Register.Find.Reunite: reduces cognitive load under stress. Home screen: "Register person" and "Search person".
Progressive access	ADOPT	From RedSafe: basic public functions without an account; sensitive operations require authentication/role.
Consent before sharing location/contact	ADOPT	From Register.Find.Reunite and RFL: a match must not automatically expose sensitive details.
Human mediation for uncertain cases	ADOPT	From RFL: complex matches or high-risk cases are escalated to authorized staff.
Shelter map + list	ADOPT	From Shelter Map: find services by proximity and type, with a list alternative.
Modular management and roles	ADOPT WITH SIMPLIFICATION	From RAIS: separate cases, shelters, search, and reports while avoiding an overly dense administrative console.
Exclusive dependence on Internet	REJECT	Disaster conditions require local registration and later synchronization.
Public directory of people	REJECT	Creates privacy, violence, stalking, or misuse risks; search must be scoped and auditable.
Automatic definitive match	REJECT	The system should suggest candidates; human verification and consent

Decision	Adopt / reject	Rationale
		complete the reunification process.

13. Proposed functional scope

- Home screen with two primary CTAs: Register person / Search person.
- Minimum registration: known name, alias, approximate age, optional photo, descriptive traits, relative/contact, current shelter, and consent.
- Cross-shelter search using approximate information and error tolerance.
- Matching engine that produces candidates with confidence levels, never an automatic final confirmation.
- Human verification and consent before sharing contact information or sensitive location.
- Check-in, transfer, and check-out history across shelters with role-based permissions.
- Offline-first mode for shelter staff, with synchronization queue and conflict handling.
- Map/list of shelters and service sites with operational status and capacity when available.
- Case closure states such as “reunified,” “contacted,” “transferred,” or “active search.”

14. Required annotated screenshots

The course guideline requires at least three annotated screenshots per tool. The following list specifies the exact evidence the team should capture. Screens that cannot be directly verified must not be invented; when access is restricted or activation depends on an emergency, use an authorized demo, official material, or declare the limitation.

Tool	Three required screenshots and annotations
Safe & Well	1. “Contact & Locate Loved Ones” page with Safe & Well access - annotate CTA clarity and context of use. 2. “List Myself as Safe and Well” screen - annotate number of requested fields and cognitive load. 3. Search/results screen - annotate identifying data required and information disclosed.
RedSafe	1. Services Home - annotate account-free access and module hierarchy. 2. Map of Services - annotate filters, geolocation, and point-of-interest details. 3. Offline download / Digital Vault / Messages - annotate privacy controls and authentication dependency.
Register.Find.Reunite	1. Service landing page - annotate Register / Find as primary actions. 2. Register form when the service is active or from official material - annotate fields and visibility control. 3. Find/Reunite - annotate how consent and the connection process are communicated.
RAIS	1. Login screen - annotate the institutional access barrier. 2. Menu/modules: Case Management, Assistance, Referrals, xForms, Reporting - annotate modular architecture. 3. Internal case/referral flow only with authorized access - annotate status, traceability, and information density.
Restoring Family Links	1. Home “3 steps to start a search” - annotate clarity of steps. 2. “Find nearest office” / country selector - annotate contextual guidance and languages. 3. Current-emergency form or privacy FAQ - annotate required information and consent.
American Red Cross Shelter Map	1. General map - annotate shelter icons versus other services. 2. Point detail card - annotate address, hours, and services. 3. No-result / no-shelter-visible state - annotate system message and alternative guidance.

Annotation rule: Each screenshot must include a short title, a visual marker (arrow/box/number), and a comment of no more than two lines explaining why the observed element matters for UX.

15. Customer Journey Map - Relative searching for a person

Persona: a relative who lost contact with someone during an evacuation and does not know which shelter the person is in. They may have incomplete data, be under high stress, and have intermittent connectivity.

Stage	Action	Thought / emotion	Touchpoint	Pain point	UX opportunity
1. Separation	Tries to call and asks people nearby.	"Where are they?" · high anxiety	Phone, social networks, shelter	Fragmented information; overloaded networks	Explain where to start searching and prevent duplicate requests.
2. Start search	Selects "Search person."	"I need to do this quickly." · urgency	Web/app or staff member	Does not remember exact details	Accept aliases, approximate age, last known location, and family relationships.
3. Enter information	Provides the information they know.	"Will this be enough?" · uncertainty	Guided form	Long fields or mandatory documentation	Progressive form; minimum fields; contextual help.
4. Possible matches	Receives search status or candidate matches.	"This could be them." · hope	System + staff member	False positives or excessive sensitive data	Show minimal information and explain match confidence.
5. Verification	Answers questions / confirms relationship.	"I want to be sure." · tension	Staff member, secure contact	Opaque or slow process	Clear checklist, visible status, and follow-up channel.
6. Contact / reunification	Secure contact or physical coordination becomes available.	Relief	System, phone, shelter	Location/contact exposed without permission	Consent from both parties and progressive information disclosure.
7. Closure	Case becomes reunified or contacted.	Calm	System	Data remain active unnecessarily	Visible closure, limited retention, and audit trail.

16. Customer Journey Map - Shelter staff member

Persona: an authorized employee or volunteer who registers arrivals, updates transfers, and responds to family inquiries during a high-demand emergency with uncertain connectivity.

Stage	Action	Need	Risk	UX opportunity
1. Reception	Receives the person and checks minimum information.	Register in under one minute.	Queues, stress, missing documents.	Quick mode, minimum fields, optional photo, offline save.
2. Registration	Creates/updates record and current shelter.	Avoid duplicates.	Misspelled name, alias, or double registration.	Suggest possible duplicates without blocking the flow.
3. Search / inquiry	Checks whether a relative has submitted a request.	See relevant matches.	False positives.	Explainable ranking by attributes + side-by-side comparison.
4. Verification	Confirms identity and relationship.	Maintain safety and consent.	Improper disclosure of location.	Roles, checklist, traceability, explicit consent.
5. Transfer	Records shelter transfer or exit.	Preserve case continuity.	Outdated records across sites.	Movement history + multi-shelter synchronization.
6. Reunification	Coordinates contact and closes the case.	Close without losing traceability.	Case remains active after reunification.	"Reunified/contacted" status, audit trail, retention rules.

17. Methodological limitations

- RAIS requires credentials to access operational screens. Therefore, internal navigation analysis is limited to publicly visible modules and official documentation. To fully satisfy the guideline, the team should use an authorized demo/test account or replace RAIS with a fully testable solution.
- Register.Find.Reunite only operates during emergencies. Outside an active event, screenshots of the operational flow must come from official material or a real activation; screens must not be reconstructed.
- Safe & Well is currently linked through American Red Cross, but the specific service surface may depend on an external domain/service. Final visual analysis should therefore be based on a real test session.
- Accessibility observations in this benchmark are "observable" only; they do not replace a technical WCAG audit using keyboard navigation, screen reader testing, and contrast measurement.

Submission recommendation: Keep all six profiles as an expanded benchmark. If the instructor enforces a strict 3-5 tool limit, use Safe & Well, Register.Find.Reunite, RAIS, RedSafe, and Shelter Map as the five core tools, and cite Restoring Family Links as a complementary cross-cutting reference for privacy and human mediation.

18. Sources

ID	Source	URL
[S1]	American Red Cross - Contact & Locate Loved Ones / Safe & Well	https://www.redcross.org/cruz-roja/obtener-ayuda/contactar-y-ubicar-a-los-seres-queridos.html
[S2]	American Red Cross - FAQ / Safe & Well documentation	https://www.redcross.org/faq.html
[S3]	ICRC - RedSafe, Digital Humanitarian Platform	https://www.icrc.org/en/redsafe
[S4]	ICRC - About RedSafe App / FAQ	https://www.icrc.org/en/about-redsafe-app
[S5]	Australian Red Cross - About Register.Find.Reunite	https://www.redcross.org.au/emergencies/about-register-find-reunite/
[S6]	UNHCR - Registration tools / RAIS	https://www.unhcr.org/registration-guidance/chapter3/registration-tools/
[S7]	UNHCR RAIS Demo - Sign in / public modules	https://demo.rais.unhcr.org/Login.aspx

ID	Source	URL
[S8]	UNHCR RAIS Egypt - public instance	https://egypt.rais.unhcr.org/Login.aspx
[S9]	ICRC - Restoring Family Links home	https://familylinks.icrc.org/home
[S10]	ICRC - Restoring Family Links FAQ	https://familylinks.icrc.org/frequently-asked-questions
[S11]	American Red Cross - Find Open Shelters and Disaster Relief Services	https://www.redcross.org/get-help/disaster-relief-and-recovery-services/find-an-open-shelter.html
[S12]	American Red Cross - FAQ (shelter lookup behavior)	https://www.redcross.org/faq.html